

Cheylea Hopkinson

Specialist in data design, project management, and logical problem solving.

Southampton, UK
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PROFILE

Senior data and analytics professional with 8+ years' experience designing and delivering end-to-end data, BI and analytical solutions. Experienced across data engineering, architecture, analytics and machine learning, with a track record of building reporting functions from the ground up and a background in leading technical teams and data migrations. Currently leading Power BI development while developing analytics-ready data infrastructure in Azure Synapse and PySpark. Earlier career experience in fintech includes developing credit-risk models and integrating analytical solutions into lending application processes.

WORK EXPERIENCE

The Workdry Group, Chandler's Ford – *Power BI Lead*

DECEMBER 2025 – PRESENT

- Leads the development of a greenfield enterprise reporting suite spanning revenue, assets, customers and operational performance, translating complex business requirements into scalable analytical solutions. Is Scrum Master.
- Design and maintain enterprise Power BI semantic models, including data modelling, DAX, security and reusable reporting architecture.
- Develop and manage the analytics gold layer within Azure Synapse using PySpark, transforming warehouse data into reliable, analytics-ready datasets.
- Partner with senior Finance and operational stakeholders to define KPIs, reporting requirements and analytical approaches that support commercial decision-making.
- Support data engineers and analysts across warehouse development, testing, debugging and modelling, providing technical guidance across the wider data function.

Southampton City Council, Southampton – *Principal Data Architect*

APRIL 2024 – DECEMBER 2025

- Led a team of five data engineers; provided mentoring, professional development, and performance management to support both personal growth and organisational impact. Used Scrum for project delivery.
- Acted as a strategic business partner to council service areas, engaging cross-functionally to deliver reports and insights that support service improvement and reduce overspend.
- Implemented an end-to-end function for normalising KPI data and helped implement a KPI Power BI dashboard with all headline KPIs for the council with confidence intervals and regression forecasting.
- Set the standard for data infrastructure development principles, code quality, data governance and security, testing and deployment to maintain a high standard repository of SQL and Python code.
- Supported the wider organisation to uphold and deliver its overarching Data and Digital Strategy, collaborating directly with the Head of Data and Head of IT, as well as working with other Directors in how the strategy fits in with other transformation programmes.
- Provided department-wide training in SQL, Git, Power BI model design / report consumption and Python. Also mentored junior colleagues directly.

Southampton City Council, Southampton – *Principal Data Analyst*

JUNE 2022 – APRIL 2024

- Led the Adult Social Care (ASC) data team (managing two members). Administered the scoping, design, and delivery of all Power BI reports for self-serve performance and data quality monitoring for the ASC service for audiences including practitioners, councillors, and directors.
- Led analysts in configuration of new data architecture using on-premises servers in MSSQL, including delivering a revised ASC data mart from the CareDirector system and formalising principles for the wider data team.
- Introduced documentation standards and helped colleagues to account for delivering as well as using GitHub for version control.
- Led statutory return submissions for Adult Social Care, ensuring compliance with national regulations, and supported Education and other services with similar requirements.
- Worked with diverse datasets including people, population, financial, record of assessments and more.

DATA & ENGINEERING

- SQL / T-SQL
- Python / PySpark / R
- ETL / ELT
- Data Warehousing
- Dimensional Modelling
- Semantic Modelling

BI & ANALYTICS

- Power BI / DAX
- Power Query / M
- KPI Design
- Statistical Analysis
- Machine Learning
- Forecasting

CLOUD & DEVELOPMENT

- Azure Synapse / Data Factory
- Azure DevOps
- Git / GitHub
github.com/cheylea
- CI / CD

LEADERSHIP

- Technical Leadership
- Data Architecture
- Stakeholder Management
- Agile / Scrum
- Mentoring, Line Management & Team Development

EDUCATION

University of Liverpool - *MSc in Computer Science*

AUG 2021 – JANUARY 2024

- Achieved Distinction
- Studied, researched, and developed projects in different emerging trends and topics in Computer Science, including database design and Artificial Intelligence using Python
- Worked collaboratively on both group and independent coding projects.
- Completed dissertation project involving creating an online web application with Python that featured facial recognition, text recognition and blockchain technologies.

WORK EXPERIENCE (Continued)

Southampton City Council, Southampton - *Business Analyst*

MARCH 2021 – JUNE 2022

- Delivered data migration project to switch Client Management System (CMS).
- Wrote migration specifications, performed data cleansing, and tested results.
- Designed and documented business processes for the new system by working with project and business stakeholders and consultants.
- Recruited, managed, and trained junior business analysts.

Tando (Richmond Group), Bournemouth - *Head of Technology / Data Analyst and Project Manager*

DEC 2020 - MARCH 2021

- Continued existing role while managing a five-person tech team and prioritised development work using DevOps and Trello.
- Trained junior project managers and handled recruitment and appraisals.

Tando (Richmond Group), Bournemouth - *Data Analyst and Project Manager*

JUL 2020 - MARCH 2021

- Built entire Power BI business-wide reporting and created an Azure-based data warehouse.
- Worked with developers to deliver an automation “task-list” for call centre agents.
- Led early stages of a backend data migration and supported marketing analytics and A/B testing.

ClearLoans (Richmond Group), Bournemouth - *Data / BI Analyst*

SEPT 2018 - JUL 2020

- Designed reporting suite of Power BI reports and SQL-based reporting across departments.
- Developed machine-learning models in R to identify credit risk and analyse customer affordability/budget data, working with developers to integrate model outputs into the lending application process.
- Led a website optimisation project that reduced costs when running credit report and bank statement checks and improved user experience.
- Worked with developers to deliver an automation “task-list” for call centre agents.

Onefeed, Bournemouth - *PPC Account Manager and Admin Assistant*

JUL 2017 - SEPT 2018

- Managed Google Shopping ad campaigns and improved client reporting.
- Automated monthly reporting and wrote internal software training manuals.

VOLUNTARY EXPERIENCE

SOS Presents, Southampton – *Secretary / Assistant Business Manager / Committee Member*

SEP 2025 - SEPT 2026

- Served as Secretary and committee member for the charity SOS Presents, a volunteer-led musical theatre society, supporting governance, organisational planning and communications across all members and volunteers.
- Led a range of organisational improvement projects, including developing a comprehensive members' handbook, formalising policies and governance processes, and introducing new digital tools for communication, scheduling and production administration.
- Built and managed relationships with external sponsors and local businesses, developing partnerships and securing sponsorship to support productions and events.

EDUCATION (Continued)

Royal Holloway, University of London - *BSc in Mathematics*

SEPT 2013 - JUNE 2017

- Developed strong analytical and problem-solving skills across a broad range of mathematical disciplines, including statistics, probability, algorithm design and financial mathematics.
- Applied mathematical and statistical techniques to complex problems, building experience in quantitative analysis, logical reasoning and the mathematical principles underlying financial markets.